

Risk Assessment for Loose Parts & Mulch Areas



Area Name	Hazards	Risk	Likelihood	Consequences	Risk Rating	Controls	Procedure
Loose Parts Area	1. Child falling and landing: - Awkwardly on soft fall. - on another child - on a piece of equipment	Bruising	Possible	Minor	Moderate	- Check safety of equipment each morning including structures built by the children - Check the soft fall areas are clear of sticks, branches and other debris - toys and other climbing equipment are clear of elevated structures for a distance of 1m. - Ensure that the soft fall area is supervised when children are outside and playing in that area.	- Morning outdoor check - Equipment Policy - Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy - Staffing Arrangements Policy
		Cuts & abrasions	Unlikely	Minor	Low		
		Broken Bones	Rare	Moderate	Moderate		
		Spinal injury	Rare	Catastrophic	Extreme		
	2. Splinters from timbers	Low	Possible	Minor	Low	Wood surfaces checked for safety each morning.	
	3. Tools and equipment used for construction	Bruising Cuts & abrasions Broken Bones	Possible	Minor Minor Moderate	Moderate Low Moderate	- Check safety of tools and equipment before use - Children taught how to use tools safely prior to use - PPE used when necessary e.g. gloves, eye glasses	

Woodchips in Loose parts area	• Child choking on mouthed woodchips • Child putting woodchips into ears • Children throwing woodchips • Animal faeces in bark softfall	Death from asphyxiation Ruptured ear drum Eye injury Poor hygiene and diseases and/or infection from animal faeces	Possible	Catastrophic	Extreme	• Educators supervise toddlers using this area • Infants/Babies are to have direct supervision with educators monitoring at all times. • Woodchip soft fall need to be air rate to a minimum depth of 300mm. • Mulch is raked weekly to check for foreign object and to air rate it.	• All staff have current first aid and resuscitation certificates • Staffing Arrangements Policy • Morning outdoor check
Rocks surrounding Loose parts area	• Falls from the rocks.	Bruising	Possible	Minor	Moderate	• Supervision when children are playing in area	• Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy • Staffing Arrangements Policy
		Cuts & abrasions	Unlikely	Minor	Low		
		Broken Bones	Rare	Moderate	Moderate		
		Cuts & abrasions	Unlikely	Minor	Low		
		Sprains or Broken Bones	Rare	Moderate	Moderate		
		Head injury from falls	Rare	Catastrophic	High		

Ropes	- Choking hazards by ropes - Ropes pulled or wrapped tightly around child's body or limbs	Death from asphyxiation Rope Burn Reduced blood or loss of blood flow to limbs	Rare Possible Possible	Catastrophic Minor Moderate	High Moderate High	- Supervision of children - Discussion of risks with children - Educators are have knowledge of children skills and monitor risks with design and construction changes. - Fixed ropes should not have fixed sections that loops smaller enough to entrap a head. i.e. no smaller than 300mm in diameter.	- Equipment Policy - Physical Environment (Workplace Safety, Learning and Administration) Policy - Staff Arrangements Policy
	Tyres		Rare	Major	Moderate	- Visual check of inner circle of tyres. - Brush inner circle of tyres weekly.	- Morning outdoor check - Equipment Policy - Physical Environment Policy
	Tyre Inner Tubes	- Explosion due to air expansion in high heat. - Digestion of rubber pieces if tyre designates. - Cuts from inner tube value.	- Possible damage to hearing due to loud explosion - Damage to skin or eyes if rubber piece in pack with force. - Choking on rubber pieces - Cuts to body include eye damage	Possible Possible Possible	High Extreme High	- Use inner tubes in shade and/or semi shaded area of the yard. - Ensure that they are not left out in direct sunlight. - Particular attention should be made to them during summer and high temperature days. - If inners are broken ensure any small pieces are disposed of safely. - Check that inner tube values are securely covered over with duct tape.	- Morning outdoor check - Equipment Policy - Physical Environment Policy - Staffing Arrangements Policy

Pallets	• Toxicity of wood • Protruding nails • Splinters	Digestion of toxins through mouth or contained skin. Absorption of toxins through skin.	Unlikely	Moderate	Moderate	• Don't use pallets that show the IPPC Logo. It shows it was treated with Methyl Bromide a toxic chemical coating. • Don't use pallets that have clearly had something spilled on them as this substance cannot be identified. • Check pallets for protruding nails or splinters or broken pieces. Fix or remove from playground.	• Morning outdoor check • Equipment Policy • Physical Environment Policy • Staffing Arrangements Policy
Other Loose Parts	• Toxicity • Choking hazards • Weight Hazard • Splinter or sharp edges, etc.	Toxic poisoning Cuts and abrasions Muscle damage Entrapment	Unlikely	Moderate	Moderate	• A visual safety check of all new parts brought onto the services grounds. • Discussions with children about the possible uses and risks with new equipment. • Supervision and regular check of parts	• Morning outdoor check • Equipment Policy • Physical Environment Policy • Staffing Arrangements Policy • Relationship with Children Policy

Review

The Management, employees, families and interested parties will monitor and review the effectiveness of this policy annually or more regularly if required.

- Reviewed by: Elizabeth Price Position: Nominated Supervisor

Date: 22/02/2023 Signature: *Elizabeth Price*

- Accepted by Committee Member: Position: Treasurer

Name: *Clare MacGregor*

Date: *23/2/23*

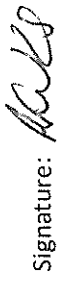
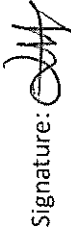
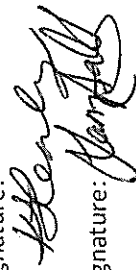
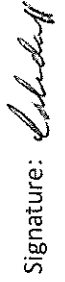
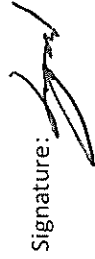
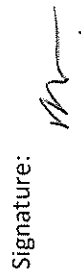
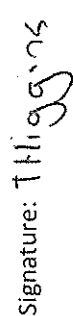
- Previously reviewed: 21/11/2019 Date for next review: 22/02/2024

Loose Parts Risk Assessment

Reviewed February 2023

Risk assessment Matrix		What would be the consequence of this emergency				
What is the likelihood that this emergency will occur?	Almost certain	Insignificant	Minor	Moderate	Major	Catastrophic
	Likely	Moderate	High	High	Extreme	Extreme
	Possible	Moderate	Moderate	High	Extreme	Extreme
	Unlikely	Low	Moderate	High	High	Extreme
	Rare	Low	Low	Moderate	High	High
		Low	Low	Low	Moderate	High

• Signed by Educators:

Name: Kareen Higgins	Signature: 	Name: Hailey Grisinger	Signature: 	Date: 24.2.23	Date: 21/3/22
Name: Olivia Mangin	Signature: 	Name: Rashelle Frankel	Signature: 	Date: 24.2.23	Date: 21.3.23
Name: Kayla Jand	Signature: 	Name: Leannettunter	Signature: 	Date: 24.2.23	Date: 23-3-23
Name: Lucy Byron	Signature: 	Name: Kathryn Sterling	Signature: 	Date: 28/2/23	Date: 23-3-23
Name: Denny Robinson	Signature: 	Name: Jasmine Van-Aabt	Signature: 	Date: 28.2.23	Date: 23.3.23
Name: Tyler Cook	Signature: 	Name: Calida Holstein	Signature: 	Date: 28.2.23	Date: 24/3/23
Name: Giam Gungun	Signature: 	Name: Louise Thurgood	Signature: 	Date: 28.2.23	Date: 28-3-23
Name: Kayla Wilson	Signature: 		Signature: 	Date: 3/3/23	Date:
Name: Robin Briggs	Signature: 		Signature: 	Date: 3/3/23	Date:
Name: Amie Jacobs	Signature: 		Signature: 	Date: 20/3/23	Date:
Name: Taleah Higgins	Signature: 		Signature: 	Date: 20.3.23	Date:

